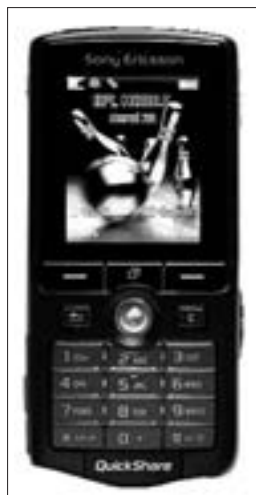


3.2 Handset Form Factors

Mobile phones come in a variety of different physical styles or form factors that define the design and shape of the device and the arrangement of the various elements on it. Manufacturers are continuously striving to make mobile phones thinner and lighter and to come up with innovative designs. Different form factors for cell phones affect the size (and therefore the portability), functionality, ergonomics and usability of these devices. Users may prefer one form factor over the other based on their specific preferences and requirements.



A Candy bar Phone

Though there are many form factors available in the market, most mobile handsets can be classified under the following broad categories:

Bar

Also referred to as “candy bar,” this is the most basic of handset form factors. Like a bar of chocolate, the phone is rectangular in shape, and does not have any hinges or moving parts. You’ll find a display screen and the standard set of number keys. Depending upon the specific phone model, you may also find soft keys, ‘answer’ and ‘end’ buttons, and navigation keys. The screen and all these keys are placed on the front of the device. Since the keys are exposed, most phones using this form factor also provide a key-guard feature that prevents the keys from being pressed accidentally when it’s in your pocket.

Clamshell

Also referred to as folder, a clamshell phone consists of two halves joined by a hinge. The upper half usually sports the screen